La Liga Player Performance Analysis Summary

Business Case

This project analyzes La Liga player data to understand the key drivers of goal scoring, evaluate player efficiency, and compare team playing styles. The goal is to generate insights that can support decision-making in player evaluation, recruitment, and tactical strategy.

Objectives

- Identify which performance metrics most strongly influence goal scoring
- Determine whether attacking output is driven by playing time or efficiency
- Compare team styles to assess reliance on individual players vs collective play

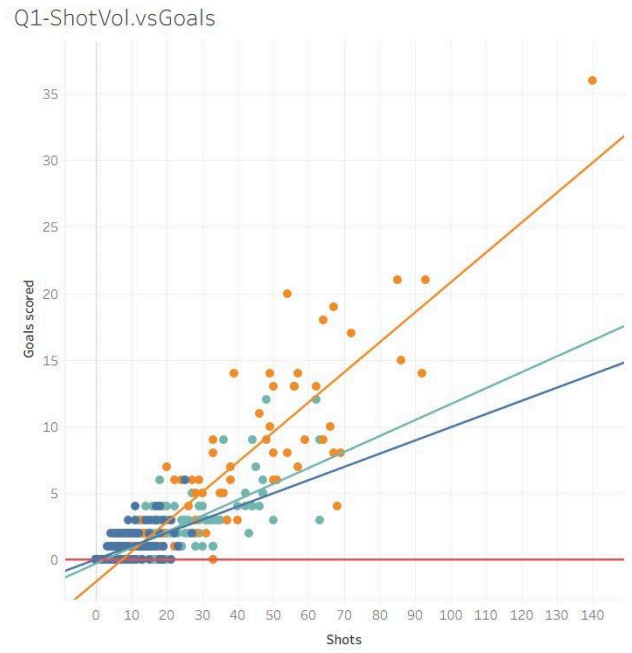
Methodology

- Cleaned dataset and corrected formatting issues (e.g., minutes played)
- Filtered out players with low playing time (<300 minutes) to ensure meaningful comparisons
- Created calculated metrics:
    - Goals per 90
    - Total Contributions (Goals + Assists)
- Built Tableau visualizations (scatter plots, stacked bar charts)

Questions

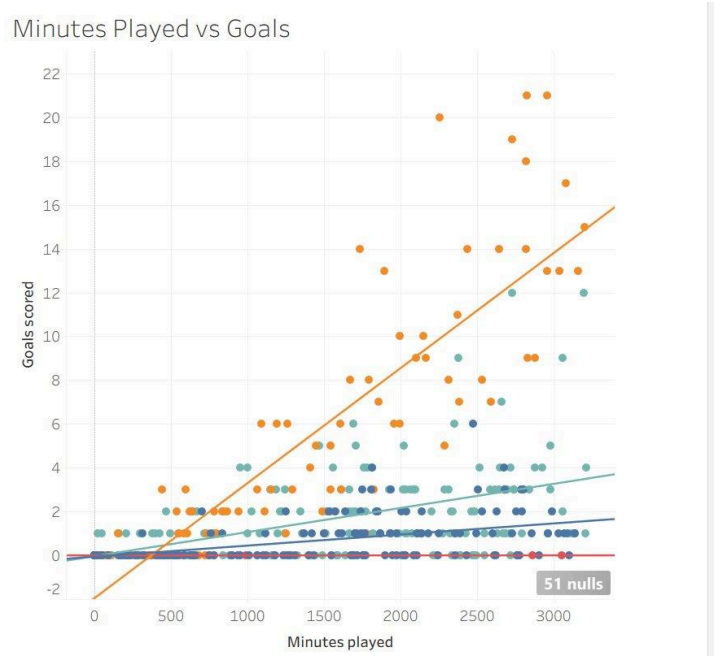
Q1: What player performance metrics most strongly influence goal scoring?

Answer:
Shots on target are the strongest predictor of goals scored, followed by total shots. Other variables such as assists and through balls have weaker relationships, while minutes played contributes more to opportunity than actual scoring efficiency.



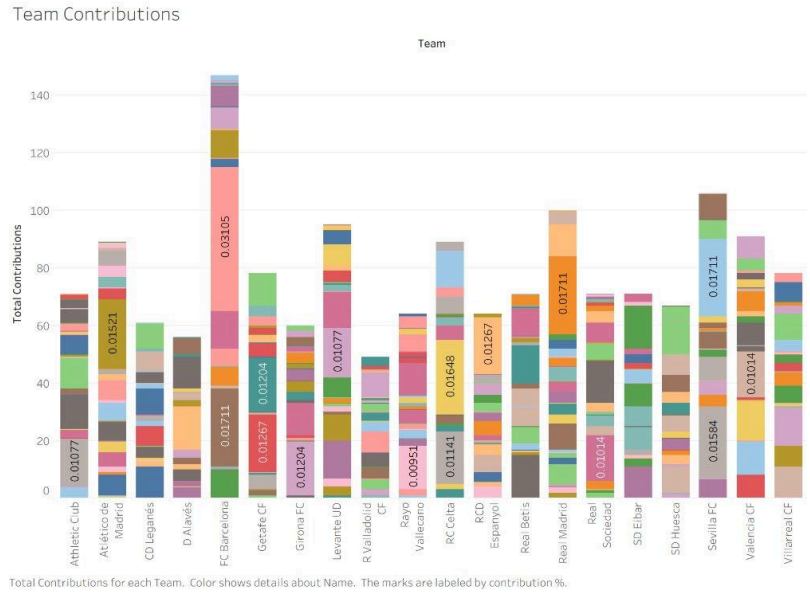
Q2: Does more playing time lead to higher attacking output, or are some players more efficient?

Answer:
While players with more minutes generally accumulate higher totals, the relationship is not consistent. Per-90 metrics show that some players are significantly more efficient, producing more goals and assists relative to their playing time.



Q3: How do team playing styles differ, and which teams rely more on collective play versus individual stars?

Answer:
Teams differ in how attacking output is distributed. Some rely heavily on one or two key players, while others show a more balanced distribution across the squad.



Insights & Recommendations

- Prioritize **shots on target and per-90 metrics** when evaluating attacking players
- Identify **high efficiency players** who may be undervalued due to limited minutes
- Encourage **balanced team contributions** to reduce reliance on individual players
- Focus on improving **shot quality** rather than simply increasing shot volume

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Conclusion

Player performance and team success are influenced not just by total output, but by **efficiency and distribution of contributions**. Using per-90 metrics and understanding team structure provides a more accurate and actionable view of performance in La Liga.